

Moving to Tokyo, Japan!



Life in Japan

Imagine stepping into a place where old traditions meet the latest innovations, where each neighbourhood offers something new to explore, and where culture, food, and creativity fill every day. Moving to Japan isn't just about work—it's an adventure. Here in Tokyo, you'll experience the balance and dedication that shape Japanese life, from peaceful temples to the city's vibrant energy, to the incredible flavors of Japanese cuisine. Tokyo is a place like no other, with a unique mix of past and future, and it's ready to welcome you to one of the most exciting work environments in the world!

However, before you make the jump, there are few things you need to know about the process (especially about the finances) that will allow you to get the best possible chances of starting your life here.

Salary

The salary range for software engineers in Japan are much less than other countries like US, Canada, Australia, Europe, etc. Also, many companies prefer to hire people already in Japan due to the risks and waiting time from

hiring people abroad. To get their first job in Japan, many times people will need to be extra flexible on salary at first to get their foot in the door here in Japan.

The average budget for newcomers to Japan is about 6 - 8 million yen per year (gross salary for mid - senior engineers). This would be about a 5 - 7 million yen per year net salary after taxes, insurance contributions/deductions, etc. There will be more opportunity to raise your salary after a year or two once you've assimilated and proven yourself in the company and country.

You will automatically be enrolled in Health and Employment insurances and a pension plan. We will also pay your commuting costs to the office.

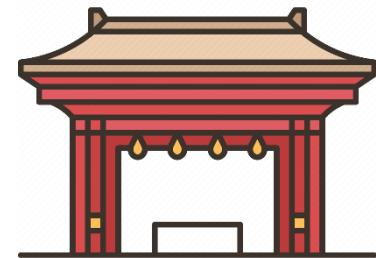
Living Costs

Although salaries are lower compared to some other countries, the living costs here in Japan can be much cheaper as well. Here are 3 links below to common living areas for newcomers to Japan. Tokyo being the most expensive of the three. Saitama is the furthest from offices in Tokyo, but it's the cheapest.

Tokyo: [Cost of Living in Tokyo. Oct 2024. Prices in Tokyo](#)

Setagaya: [Cost of Living in Setagaya-ku. Jun 2024. Prices in Setagaya-ku](#)

Saitama: [Cost of Living in Saitama. Oct 2024. Prices in Saitama](#)



No Relocation Package

There will be no relocation package provided. You will need to take care of your own moving costs such as plane ticket, apartment costs and visa application fee (we will pay you back the visa application fee after 6 months of working).

Contract to Perm

Most positions for candidates that require a visa will start on a continuous 3-month contract. All the positions are long-term, and the goal is to have you eventually convert to a permanent position with the team. Usual timeline for conversion is between 6 – 18 months (not guaranteed). In Japan, your visa will stick with you and not the company. So if you decide to stop the contract or leave the company, you will keep the visa and you can find a new company to work for here in Japan.

Salary Payment Delay

Your salary here in Japan will be paid the month after your work. For example, if you start working on January 1st, your pay for your January work will be paid on Feb 25th. Of course, this means that if you leave the company, you will still get another pay check the month after you leave. This means you need to be financially ready to be without salary here in Japan for 1 month.